footprint in this region, but Russia's military presence and its role in energy politics give it greater political influence.

For both Russia and India, China is the most significant neighbour. The marked upswing in Russia–China relations in recent years has coincided with increasing discord between India and China. The thrust by Prime Minister Modi to broad base India–Russia cooperation beyond defence to include trade, energy, natural resources, and research, is informed by the premise that such a vibrant partnership with India could enhance Russia's resistance to Chinese pressures for acting against India's security interests. As a major arms importer from Russia, India is particularly sensitive to the nature of Russia's military-technical cooperation with China. As noted earlier, Russia's strategic perspectives and concerns about Chinese reverse engineering had, until recently, ensured that India received the more sophisticated technologies. After the recent significant expansion in Russia–China defence and military cooperation, with systems like the S-400 being acquired by both the countries, Indian concerns about what Russia was transferring to China would likely have been on the agenda for confidential discussion between the Indian and Russian leaders. In 2017, President Putin publicly addressed India's concerns by telling an Indian journalist that "there is no other country in the world" to which Russia transfers the sensitive technologies that it sells to India.[20] Russia–China military transfers will remain a continuing area of Indian concern and scrutiny.

The 20th India–Russia summit in Vladivostok signalled another important step in broad basing the bilateral engagement, flagging India's interest in the economic opportunities in the Russian Far East and drawing Russia into a dialogue on a cooperation architecture in the Indo-Pacific. The last aspect has geopolitical significance. Russia is comfortable with the Asia Pacific construct and